MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 5/20/2026

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
April 15, 2026

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda as presented with changes, **Motion carried.**

*Changes: Finance and Administration: temporarily remove D. Software and Services Purchase

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of March 18, 2026, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Bill Simpson, Clare County Road Commission Vice Chairman, thanked the Board of Commissioners for attending the recent Career and Technical Education (CTE) Informational meeting.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Mobile Medical Response Report – No Discussion
2. Letter from Harrison City Manager, Justin Cavanaugh – Discussed during New Business

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps stated that there are minimal legislative updates to report because of Spring Break. The two year price lock with the current health insurance provider is set to expire soon so Administrator Phelps is going through the bidding process. She reported that the County Audit is complete and she is in progress with several grants.

Additionally, Administrator Phelps announced that a total of three bids for the comprehensive software solution project have been submitted and further review is required for two companies that submitted bids late in the process. One of the companies is significantly less than the current company used, BS&A Cloud Software. The Recovery Court programming has expanded because of recent Opioid Settlement funding. Lastly, Administrator Phelps reported the County budget is historically 54.17% expensed at this time of the year; it is currently 46% expensed indicating that the County remains in a strong financial position.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Pete Preston – Equalization
   Pete Preston, the Clare County Equalization Director, informed the Board of Commissioners that the Equalization season has come to an end and it is time for them to adopt and approve the L-4024 and L-4037. He reported that the local units in Clare County will go through an audit from the State Tax Commission this year.

JUSTICE

1. Sheriff's Department Sally Port Contract
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the contract with Mann Construction Inc. in the amount of $206,905.24, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gilmore, Gross, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Equalization
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Resolution #26-07 and accept the equalized value recommendation presented by the County Equalization Director of $2,500,584,834 (Two billion, Five Hundred Million, Five Hundred Eighty Four Thousand, Eight Hundred Thirty Four), roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gilmore, Gross, Hoefling, Housler and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. State Tax Commission Assessment L-4037
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the State Tax Commission Assessment Roll Certification, County Board of Commissioner, CBC L-4037 and allow the Chair to sign, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Personal Real Property Totals
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Personal and Real Property totals, L-4024 and allow the Chair to sign, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Haskell, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - continued

4. Drain
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to pass Resolution #26-08 approving the special assessment roll as presented by the Drain Commissioner, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

5. Materials Management
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the contract with Resource Recycling Systems Inc. (RRS) to provide professional consulting services to support Clare County's participation in the Heartland Multi-County Management Plan (MMP) process, as authorized under Part 115 of the Natural Resources and Environmental Protection Act (MCL 324.11571-324.11587) in the amount of $42,404.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of March 16, 2026 in the amount of $101,446.30 and the meeting minutes of March 30, 2026 in the amount of $120,754.06, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the expenditures for the month of March 2026, in the amount of $2,140,926.19 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,353,034.22, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Haskell, Housler and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION – continued

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Budget Adjustment #26-55 in the amount of $273,874.64 and Budget Adjustment #26-70 in the amount of $75,000.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

4. Software and Services Purchase – Removed from Agenda

5. Child Care Fund Appropriation
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to appropriate $100,000.00 from the General Fund to the Child Care Fund, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Hoefling
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

6. Personnel Committee Discussion and Recommendation
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve adjustments to administrative and non-union wages consistent with the findings of the compensation study, as recommended by the Personnel Committee, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

7. Restricted Fund
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Housler to move $280,000.00 from the ending Fund Balance into the restricted fund for Capital Improvements, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gilmore, Gross and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

8. Enhanced Voting
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to allow the County Clerk to sign the Enhanced Voting contract for election night reporting to our constituents, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Gilmore
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION – continued

9. Budget Calendar
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Budget Calendar for Fiscal Year (FY) 2027, **Motion carried.**

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. She reported that her office recently sent out under 6,000 notices so they have been busy.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings and had no report.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Majewski reported that he has attended his meetings and has noticed that data centers are a recent hot topic.

Commissioner Gross stated that data centers has also been the talk at one of his townships.

Commissioner Haskell gave a shout out to Dewayne Rogers at the Clare County Road Commission for receiving an Impact Award recently. He also inquired on the availability of utilizing Opioid funds for the Pre-trial Committee he serves on.

Commissioner Kleinhardt gave a brief report on a recent Northern Michigan Counties (MAC) meeting in Roscommon.

Commissioner Housler had no report but added that her townships as well are not interested in data centers.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported that the Easter Eggstravaganza at the Clare County Airport was a success. He briefly explained an upcoming grant opportunity through the Michigan Department of Transportation (MDoT) for the Airport. Lastly, Commissioner Ambrozaitis stated that the new Director of the Michigan Veterans Affair Agency (MVAA), Terry Sabo, visited the Clare County Veterans Services noting it was the first time a MVAA Director did so.

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

PUBLIC COMMENT

Airport Manager Corder expressed gratitude to Hayes Township, the City of Harrison and Commissioner Fancon for their help in making the Easter Eggstravaganza a success. He also encouraged the Board of Commissioners to support the upcoming grant opportunities as explained by Commissioner Ambrozaitis. He reiterated the importance of the Clare County Airport with a reminder that in September 2025 a pilot had to make an emergency landing. If the Airport had been closed, the pilot may have had a disastrous outcome.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

1. Road Commission Discussion
   The Board of Commissioners discussed whether the Board of County Road Commissioners should have five board members or be reduced back to three board members. The intent for increasing to five board members was to have better communication between the Road Commission and the townships.

   Due to a lack of township meeting attendance from some of the Road Commission board members, communication has not improved. It was decided to give the Road Commission board an opportunity to improve their attendance at township meetings before the Clare County Board of Commissioners make a decision to reduce back to three board members.

2. Windows Discussion
   Administrator Phelps shared pictures of the bug infested and rotted windows on the Clare County Courthouse building. She informed the Board of Commissioners that she currently has one bid to replace some windows and will work on receiving one more bid before presenting it to the Board.

3. GFL Expansion Discussion and Support Request
   Administrator Phelps read a letter of support for a proposed transfer station with an integrated recycling component in Hayes Township. After Commissioner Fancon answered questions from the Board of Commissioners and members of the public in attendance, the Board signed the letter of support.

4. City of Harrison Zoning Concerns Discussion
   After some discussion, it was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to accept Resolution #26-09 from the Board stating the position on maintaining local zoning rather than having it transferred to the State, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Gilmore, Fancon, Haskell, Housler and Majewski
   Nays: (2) being Commissioners Gross and Ambrozaitis
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:31a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners